

外研社杯·国才杯·2017 年阅读大赛复赛第二场

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people. Please note there are two extra options you do not need.

A. William Shakespeare	1. Man is born free, and everywhere he is in chains. Here’ s one who thinks he is the master of others, yet he is more enslaved than they are
B. Ernest Hemingway	2. If you would go up high, then use your own legs! Do not let yourselves carried aloft; do not seat yourselves on other people’ s backs and heads
C. Jean-Jacque Rousseau	3. If people bring so much courage to this world the world has to kill them to break them, so of course it kills them. The world breaks every one and afterward many are strong at the broken places.
D. Napoleon Bonaparte	
E. Friedrich Nietzsche	

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

When Kate T. Parker began photographing her two daughters for her “Strong Is the New Pretty” photo series, it was to show her girls the beauty in their own strength. Since the series went viral in 2015, Parker’ s work has expanded to show the tenacious spirit found within not only the girls in her own home, but girls across the country. Parker’ s photos can be found in her new book *Strong Is the New Pretty*—a collection of photos and stories about powerful young girls Parker encountered throughout the U.S. “My main goal was _____.” Parker said. “There are almost 200 girls in this book... they represent a vast number of human stories, ranging from small moments of achievement to persistent struggles against adversity.”

4. Which of the following statements might fit in the blank in the text?

- A) recording the growing processes of so many girls B) telling girls to be independent in their life C) expanding the definition of what ‘strong’ means D) publicizing my book on girls’ strength

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

Bigorexia is often referred to as the opposite of anorexia. Those living with it believe they are not muscular enough, and many go to extreme lengths to bulk up further. But in their pursuit of the “perfect body” some have gone too far, with devastating results.

Known officially as “muscle dysmorphia” , the condition is thought to affect thousands of people, mainly men, across the UK.

BBC Newsbeat joins BBC Asian Network on a journey to meet some of the people who just can’ t stop pumping iron, the gym owner who says it’ s rife, the grieving mother who believes she lost her son to Bigorexia and the medical expert who warns that this condition is being ignored.

5. According to the text, which of the following is NOT a sign of Bigorexia?

- A) A psychiatric problem with one’ s body condition. B) The thought of oneself as being too fat. C) Body-image disorder towards muscularity. D) Working out compulsively and constantly.

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

Some people are born into families that encourage education; others are from families that are against it. Some are born into flourishing economies; others, into war and destitution. I want you to be successful, and I want you to become wealthy. But realize that not all success is due to hard work and not all poverty is due to laziness. Keep this in mind when judging people, including yourself

6. What is this text mainly about?

- A) Rational thinking B) Diversity of culture C) Wealth polarization D) Criterion of success

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

The Mediterranean diet—rich in fruits, vegetables, fish, olive oil, nuts and whole grains—has long been hailed as a heart-healthy eating plan. But new research suggests its health benefits may be _____ to the rich and well-educated.

For the study, a team of Italian scientists reviewed diets, incomes and education levels of nearly 19,000 men and women.

The investigators found the Mediterranean diet was associated with about a 60 percent lower risk of heart disease and stroke among those with higher incomes and more education. The same was not true for those with fewer resources—even though they followed a similar eating plan.

7. Which of the following word best fits in the blank in the text?

- A) related B) limited C) familiar D) comprehensible

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

The immune system is the body’ s natural defense against germs. When a germ invades, the immune system sends special cells to fight it off. Sometimes, though, the immune system is not naturally strong enough to prevent a disease from seriously harming someone or even killing them. But there’ s a way to give the immune system a boost. It’ s known as a vaccine.

Vaccines are substances that prepare the immune system to fight a disease-causing germ or other pathogens by imitating an infection. They trick the immune system into making a “memory” of that germ without ever having to fight the real germ in the first place. Now, when the immune system encounters the real pathogen—whether it’ s a virus, bacterium or other microbes—it is ready to attack it. As a result, the vaccinated person doesn’ t get sick.

8. Where is the text most probably taken from?

- A) A guideline for clinical practice. B) A popular scientific article. C) A public speech manuscript. D) A blueprint for vaccine design.

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *In each of the following options there are two advertisements separated by “/” with the same promoted product in the brackets. Read the following advertisements and answer the question.*

9. Which of the following is a mismatch between the advertisements and the product?

- A) Melt in your mouth, not in your hand. / A smooth, silky taste with a hint of milk. (Chocolates) C) Obey your thirst. / Behind that healthy smile, there’ s a Crest kid. (Drinks)
B) Time is what you make of it. / Witness history, grasp the future. (Watches) D) Poetry in motion, dancing close to me. / Engineered to move the human spirit. (Cars)

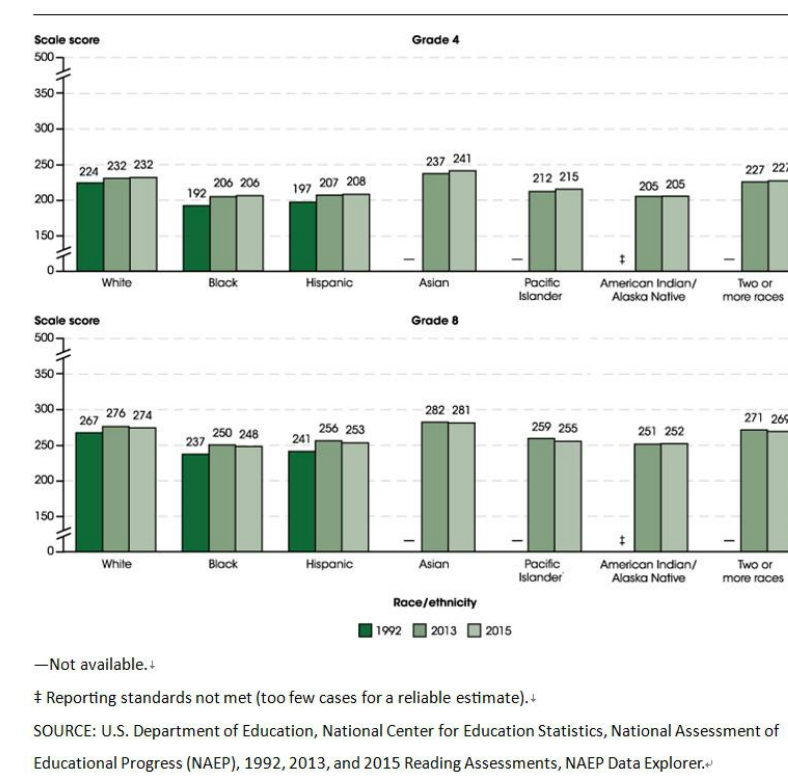
Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: The following bar charts show the Average National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP) reading scale scores of 4th- and 8th-grade students by race/ethnicity in the years of 1992, 2013, and 2015.

Answer the question according to the charts.

10. Which of the following is an INCORRECT description of the charts?

- A) The average reading scores of White, Black, and Hispanic 8th-grade students were higher in 2015 than in 1992, which is consistent with the conditions at grade 4.
- B) From 1992 through 2015, the average reading scores of White 4th- and 8th-graders were higher than those of their Black and Hispanic peers.
- C) The average reading scores of 4th-graders of each racial group saw a general uptrend from 1992 to 2015, while those scores of 8th-graders slightly declined in general.
- D) The White-Black and White-Hispanic average reading score gaps have narrowed from 1992 to 2013 and then to 2015 at grade 8.



Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Read the definition of the following logical fallacy. Answer the question according to the definition.

Red Herring

The fallacy of *red herring*, less colorfully named *irrelevant thesis*, occurs when one tries to distract one's audience by invoking a consideration that is irrelevant to the topic under discussion. (This fallacy probably gets its name from the fact that a rotten herring, or a cured herring, which is reddish, will throw pursuing hounds off the right track.)

11. Which of the following is NOT an example of the *red herring* fallacy?

- A) Not until astronauts sailed through space around the moon and could see its back side did we have adequate reason to believe that the moon even had a back side.
- B) I am pretty sure that evolution is not a very good explanation for human life. Anyway, I am pretty offended that anyone would suggest that I came from a monkey.
- C) The crime in this city has increased lately. However, let's consider that the weather has changed as well. Things change over time. Sometimes they are linked, sometimes they are not.
- D) Unfortunately, we have to lay off 5% of the workforce. It's important to note that the product we create is exceptionally flawless and we thank our manufacturing department for that.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Look at the following picture and answer the question.

12. Which of the following logical fallacies does the picture illustrate?

- A) **Ad Hominem:** It is a fallacy in which a claim or argument is rejected on the basis of some irrelevant facts about the author of or the person presenting the claim or argument. Translated from Latin to English, "Ad Hominem" means "against the man" or "against the person."
- B) **Genetic:** It is used if a critic attempts to discredit or support a claim or an argument because of its origin (genesis) when such an appeal to origins is irrelevant.
- C) **The fallacy of Composition:** It is committed when a conclusion is drawn about a whole based on the features of its constituents when, in fact, no justification is provided for the inference.
- D) **Amphiboly:** It is an error due to taking a grammatically ambiguous phrase in two different ways during the reasoning.



They're paper clips! You can't make something beautiful out of paper clips!

Question 13 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Physicists have built devices to make me move quickly. My last eight letters can be commonly found in newspaper, magazines, and journals. What am I?

13. I am _____.

Question 14 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following text and answer the question according to the text.

Many people report that exposure to certain foods and drinks such as cheese, chocolate, and red wine, is associated with the onset of migraine headaches. Other people report that exposure to certain smells (especially strong perfumes) seems to trigger a migraine headache, and some note that exposure to bright and flickering lights can be followed by a migraine. It would seem that a person with a tendency to get migraines should try to find out which of these situations is associated with the onset of the headache and then avoid this stimulus.

14. All of the following, if true, would make the above recommendation impractical EXCEPT:

- A) The presence of a known trigger doesn't always cause a migraine. C) The time delay between the trigger and the onset of the headache can make it exceptionally difficult to identify the trigger.
- B) In a high proportion of cases the patients report multiple triggers for their headaches. D) Most of the known triggers are common and almost unavoidable features of modern life.

Question 15 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

Rumor Has It

A German shepherd named “Rumor” was awarded “Best in Show” at the 141st annual *Westminster Kennel Club Dog Show* in New York City. When the announcement was made, the crowd at Madison Square Garden erupted into applause. But no one was as elated as Tom Ryan, Rumor’s handler and co-owner.

Rumor is 5 years old and is named after the hit Adele song “Rumor Has It” . She was a favorite at last year’ s Westminster competition, but was bested by a German shorthaired pointer named CJ.

Nearly 3,000 dogs competed this year at Westminster. Winners are determined through a process of elimination. Rumor beat six other dogs for



the prize: A boxer named “Devlin” , a Norwegian elkhound named “Duffy” , a miniature poodle named “Aftin” , a Norwich terrier named “Tanner” , a powder puff of a Pekingese named “Chuckie” , and Adrian, an Irish setter. Adrian was selected the Best-in-Show runner-up.

____ 15 ____ They were originally bred as sheepherders, in Germany. Today, the dogs often work alongside police officers and firefighters as search-and-rescue dogs. They are also popular as service dogs for the blind or hearing impaired.

Rumor is the second German shepherd to be named top dog at Westminster. The last time one won the nation’ s premier dog competition was in 1987.

“The German shepherd standard talks about quality and nobility,” Westminster judge Thomas Bradley III said. “When you recognize it, it hits you at home, and that’ s what it really is. Rumor is just magnificent.”

15. Which of the following best fits in the numbered space in the text?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A) There is an interesting saying about how German shepherds got the name. | C) Rumor has been considered as one of the best German shepherds since then. |
| B) German shepherds are well-known for their intelligence and loyalty. | D) In the past, German shepherds were not usually taken to the competition. |

Questions 16-17 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text about procrastination and answer the questions according to the text.*

Close your eyes. Imagine yourself finishing that tedious months-long project you’ ve been dreading.

Think about the papers you’ re preparing on your desk, the documents you need to print, the conversations you’ ll need to have to finish the project and even what you’ ll wear on the presentation day or how it will feel to finally ace the project—the more vivid the picture is in your mind, the better.

The exercise seems simple, but some recent research suggests that visualising yourself in the future could be a novel way to beat procrastination.

The theory goes like this: most of us aren’ t particularly good at picturing how our immediate actions will affect us in the long term. But if we’ re constantly picturing ourselves at a later point in life, and how our daily decisions affect us in the future, it can help us make better immediate decisions because it’ s easier to imagine the long-term consequences.

Saving for the future

Part of the idea comes from research by Hal Hershfield, psychologist and associate professor of marketing at UCLA’ s Anderson School of Management, who studies how our perception of time can alter decision-making.

In a series of four experiments, people were asked to interact with their “future selves” —digitally altered portraits which showed them in old age—through a virtual reality program. Hershfield found that those who interacted with their future selves were then more likely to allocate money towards a hypothetical retirement savings account.

Hershfield says we often behave in ways that can be detrimental in the long term: “It’ s very similar to eating unhealthy today and suffering the consequences over time.”

But “when we help people visualise and more deeply consider their future selves it increases the tendency to act in ways that are more **future-oriented**.”

This idea can be applied to time management.

16. Which of the following is TRUE according to the text?

- A) The act of visual imagery is to a large extent practical. C) Procrastination is detrimental to one’ s physical and mental health.
- B) Digital devices were used for Hershfield’ s four experiments. D) Most people do not really know how to interact with their future selves.

17. Decide whether the following description is a good elaboration of the term **future-oriented** in the text:

“It may feel inconsequential to put off a project for another day and scroll through Facebook for the afternoon. But by picturing yourself dealing with the extra stress caused by this small decision once the deadline arrives a month down the track, it can help you get back to work.”

- A) Yes. B) No. C) Hard to tell.

Question 18 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

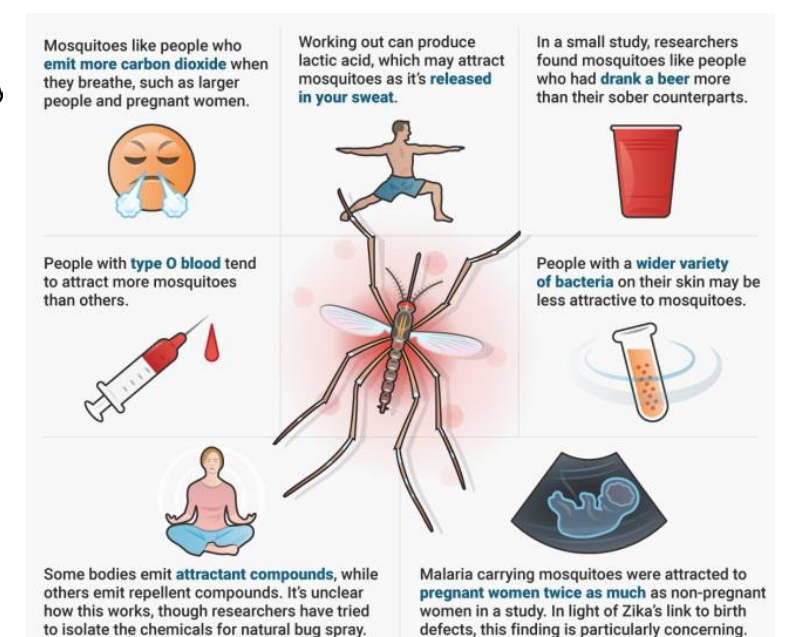
Directions: Read the text about mosquitoes. Decide whether the statement is True or False according to the text.

Mosquitoes choose their prey—you perhaps—based on a bunch of factors. But there’ s good news: Some things that might make you attractive to them can actually be changed. Scientific studies have found evidence supporting several factors that encourage mosquitoes to seek you out.

These studies often involve different kinds of mosquitoes, however, so the things that attract them to you may vary depending on which species are nearby. And many of these studies are small, so keep in mind that these are preliminary hypotheses, not ironclad conclusions.

Mosquitoes are known to transmit deadly diseases like Zika, malaria, yellow fever, and West Nile virus. So even though the things that attract the bugs aren’ t fully understood, it’ s wise to try to reduce your allure as much as you can.

18. Mosquitoes are more likely to be attracted by certain chemicals such as carbon dioxide and lactic acid; some people are genetically more attractive to



mosquitoes, but it can be changed.

A) True B) False

Questions 19-21 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text about the Universe's dark matter and answer the questions according to the text.*

New Map of Universe's Dark Matter

Researchers have released the most accurate map ever produced of the dark matter in our Universe.

The team surveyed more than 26 million galaxies in the largest study of its kind.

The map will help scientists understand what dark matter is made from and learn more about another mysterious phenomenon called "dark energy" .

The results have been released by the international Dark Energy Consortium.

According to Professor Ofer Lahav of University College London, and chair of the Advisory Board of the Consortium, the map would provide new insights into how the Universe operates.

"Dark energy and dark matter represent probably one of the biggest mysteries in the world of science. And this has generated a lot of interest across the whole of science because it is a major shakeup. And actually we still don't know what it is." he said.

Scientists have suspected that there is more material in the Universe than we can observe for more than 80 years.

The movement of stars and galaxies indicates that the Universe is also made up of invisible particles called "dark matter" .

In 1998, two teams of astronomers discovered that the expansion of the Universe was accelerating, rather than slowing down, as the theory at the time suggested. Physicists speculated that the acceleration was caused by something they named "dark energy" .

Since then, observations have indicated that dark energy and dark matter together account for 96% of the Universe. The challenge has been to find ways of studying these invisible phenomena in detail.

"We cannot just say we don't know what it is, we have to make an effort to see what it is." according to Professor Lahav.

The Dark Energy Survey is the most ambitious effort to date. It began in 2004 and involves 400 scientists from 26 institutions in seven countries.

The survey involves taking pictures of 26 million galaxies across a large expanse of the sky using the Blanco telescope in Chile. To do this, the research team had to build one of the most sensitive cameras ever built.



The 570-megapixel camera is capable of detecting light from galaxies that are eight billion light years away.

By studying the way in which the light was distorted by the intervening dark matter, researchers were able to calculate its distribution. And by studying the way in which the distribution changes over time they can calculate the way in which dark energy acts on it.

The team was also able to infer the amounts of dark energy and dark matter from the density and locations of galaxies.

The results show support for previous studies that indicate the Universe is made up of 4% ordinary matter, 26% dark matter and 70% dark energy.

The hope is that a detailed study of the map will give clues about what dark matter and dark energy might be and so lead to a more complete theory of physics.

The data released today draws from just one year of observations. The researchers plan to collect data for four more years over an even larger area of the sky. Professor Lahav says that there is much more to come.

He explained: “Once we have the full survey, 300 million galaxies and a thousand supernovae, we may be providing input for a new Einstein to tell us what does it all mean—why is the Universe made the way it is?”

Complete the following sentences with the choices A-F. Please note there are three extra options you do not need.

19. The dark matter

20. The dark energy

21. The universe

- A. was studied with the most sensitive camera in Chile
- B. was calculated of its distribution by studying how it twisted the light
- C. was found changing opposite to the experts’ former predictions
- D. was already explained with a novel theory of physics
- E. was considered to be the major component of galaxies
- F. was made up of particles visible to naked eyes

Questions 22-23 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the questions according to the information in the text.*

Disruptive technologies such as artificial intelligence and big data are changing the world of work. Retail jobs are disappearing in the U.S. while the online sellers supplanting them fill their warehouses with robots instead of human workers.



In China, manufacturing businesses that fled wealthy countries to find low-wage workers are now replacing those humans with machines. And on farms around the world, automated systems are beginning to take on backbreaking tasks like weeding lettuce. Studies have found that new technologies threaten around 40% of existing U.S. jobs, and two-thirds of jobs in the developing world.

There is one kind of job though, that is both indispensable and difficult—perhaps impossible—to automate: the kind that requires emotional skills. Artificially intelligent software is being built that can recognise emotions in people’s faces and voices, but it is a long way from simulating genuine empathy, and philosophers have been arguing for centuries that a machine with real feelings is impossible. Computers are nowhere near being able to compete with humans on the ability to really understand and connect with another human being.

If these jobs can’t be automated, and will continue to be necessary into the future, workers with emotional skills will be highly in demand in the coming decades. But, right now, the jobs that depend most on these skills are often badly compensated: a Business Insider poll put childcare workers and high school teachers in a list of the top ten most underpaid professions.

Emotional skills include all the abilities that let us recognise and respond appropriately to emotional states in ourselves and others. They’re a ubiquitous, yet largely invisible, part of a huge and perhaps surprising array of jobs. It’s the supermarket cashier pleasantly asking how you’re doing. It’s a supervisor correcting a subordinate’s mistake while making sure he still feels valued and capable. It’s a salesman watching a potential customer’s face to see if she’s sceptical about his pitch.

22. Which of the following can we infer from the text?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A) Empathy is an emotion which artificial intelligence can imitate. | C) Jobs are underpaid because workers lack high-tech skills. |
| B) Jobs needing emotional skills are not currently fairly treated. | D) Robots outperform humans in numerous fields of life. |

23. What is the best title for this text?

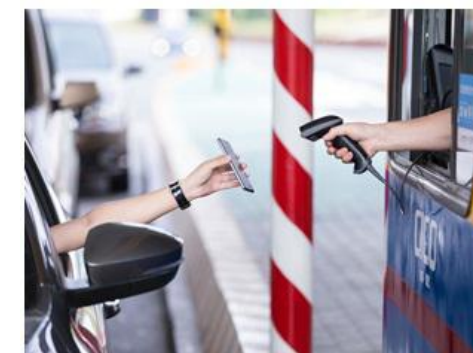
- | | |
|--|--|
| A) Emotional Skills Are Urgently Needed | C) Disruptive Effects of Technology Can Be Avoided |
| B) The Automation-Resistant Skills We Should Nurture | D) Robots Outperform Humans in Jobs |

Questions 24-31 (Suggested completion time: 30 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about cashless society. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

Nowhere is the cashless trend more obvious than in the eastern Chinese city of Hangzhou, which is home to Alibaba, the world’s largest online shopping platform.



Its mobile payment app, Alipay, and Tencent's WeChat Pay, which belong to the country's leading social messaging platform, together hold a commanding 90 percent of the market, leaving Apple Pay struggling to make inroads.

I recently spent a day in Hangzhou to see how easy it was to go cashless, and I found it somewhat ahead of other cities, including Beijing. I rode buses and subways, which all accept Alipay. I visited a major Buddhist temple, where visitors can make donations, buffing up their karma with a swipe of their phone.

I even listened to the plaintive tunes of a woman performing music on the street for change—or for a scan of a QR code, placed beside the change box.

Over a plate of noodles, a restaurateur named Ma Zhiguo told me that about half his customers pay for their meals with cellphones, and he uses his to pay most of the time too.

"I don't have to worry about getting counterfeit money, or having to make change," he explained. "When I go out, I don't have to worry about losing my money or getting robbed."

All this is a rapid and somewhat surprising development in a country where, a couple of decades ago, it wasn't even clear that credit cards were going to catch on.

Chinese Academy of Social Sciences research fellow Cheng Lian argues that this was a cultural problem.

"Traditionally, Chinese people didn't want credit cards," he says, "because they didn't want to owe anyone money."

The workaround Chinese mobile payment platforms came up with is to link people's phones to debit cards, so they don't owe anyone money.

The platforms also came up with a technical fix: by using the cellular networks smartphones use, they bypassed the often-unreliable data networks used by credit card payment terminals.

Passage B

Banks, and the Government, are desperate for us to go cashless. It's much easier and cheaper for them if we do all of our spending and earning neatly, on the Internet, without any of the fuss, bother and expense that cash produces. Bank branches and ATMs are costly and difficult to run. You have to employ security and staff and pay business rates and rent. Wouldn't it be easier if everything was cleanly done online so there was a nice easy trail to follow? Apparently consumers are coming around too.

As a millennial I'm afraid I am right in the middle of this. My phone holds more financial information than I care to think about. I bank by app and pay by Apple Pay. I can't remember the last time I went into a bank branch and I can go weeks without using a cashpoint. It's all very convenient.

But there are downsides too. I have done away with my Oyster card—a form of electronic ticket used on public transport in Greater London—meaning not only TFL (Transport for London) but my card provider know exactly where I am on the Tube network. And I can't be the only one who is more than a little concerned about the level of information Apple now holds about me—including my bank details. Yes, security is apparently tight. But scams are worryingly common, and banks are often all too quick to lay blame at the door of the consumer.

Moreover, while I am more than happy to manage my money by app, I am conscious that it's not so easy for those who did not grow up in an Internet age. Plenty of people simply find it easier, less stressful and more

convenient to pay and earn in cash. Often they are the less well-off and older people: those for whom app-based banking is a complication, not a shortcut. It's easier to budget when you have a physical bundle, and easier to avoid the exhortations of businesses to spend more than you can afford.

There's also the fact that going cashless, which is simple in London, becomes harder if you live somewhere with poor phone reception. Anyone who has waited patiently for a *recalcitrant* card machine to accept their debit card so they can pay for a coffee will know that the technology is nowhere near the stage of being reliable for all transactions.

Passage C

How much cash do you have in your pocket right now? I've got \$7, all singles. Fifteen years ago, this would have been a major problem. Sure there were debit cards and credit cards, but let's face it, not every store took debit and credit cards. Now you can walk into a Dunkin Donuts and charge a \$2 coffee. The world has changed, and even street vendors take cards. Why even carry cash?

Visa (V) and Mastercard (MA) are two great ways to play the continued transition to a cashless society. Why not American Express (AXP)? Keep in mind that Visa and Mastercard are payment processors. A bank issues credit cards, holds the debt and charges a rate of interest. Visa and Mastercard simply handle the transaction at the point of sale and collect fees on each transaction. On the other hand, American Express issues cards, sets the rates and holds the debt. AXP isn't a terrible choice for exposure to payments, but Visa and Mastercard are the clean way to play increasing payments transaction volumes without having to worry about default rates and the like.

Research shows that card payment volumes continue to grow strongly. In September 2016, Euromonitor International reported that consumer card payments had surpassed cash payments for the first time. The report showed \$23.1 trillion was spent globally via card payments. The article went on to claim that in the 2016-2021 period, card payments would show a compounded annual growth rate (CAGR) of 6.6 percent and mobile payments would see a 23 percent CAGR. It predicted cash would only grow at a 1.3 percent CAGR over the same period.

Meanwhile, fewer and fewer people are using cash. A recent survey conducted by Ipsos, a global market research and a consulting firm, for the ING bank website eZonomics found that 34 percent of respondents in Europe and 38 percent of respondents in the U.S. said they would be willing to go completely cash free. Meanwhile, 21 percent in Europe and 34 percent in the U.S. said they rarely use cash now. The story also noted that more than half of Europeans were using cash less often over the past 12 months.

Shares of Visa and Mastercard have seen robust gains over the past five years, with Visa up nearly 208 percent and Mastercard up nearly 170 percent as this trend to a cashless society picks up steam.

24. According to Passage A, which of the following is NOT true?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A) Hangzhou, where the headquarters of Alibaba locates, is leading the trend in going cashless in China. | C) It is very convenient to travel around Hangzhou a whole day without any cash, and mobile payment could cover public transportation, restaurants, and even tips for street performances. |
| B) Alipay, WeChat Pay and Apple Pay, the three most popular mobile payment apps, have taken up the | D) Mobile payment could help solve some of the problems engendered by credit card and cash payments. |

market and been equivalently favored by the consumers.

25. What has led to the decline of credit card use in China, according to Cheng Lian in Passage A?

- A) Technical defects.
- B) Unreliable networks.
- C) Chinese customs.
- D) Insufficient payment terminals.

26. What does the word *recalcitrant* in Paragraph 5 of Passage B refer to?

- A) broken
- B) naughty
- C) recessed
- D) disobedient

27. According to Passage B, who will firmly support the cashless revolution?

- A) Banks and government.
- B) The young people.
- C) Consumers in London.
- D) The poor and the old.

28. According to Passage B, which of the following may isolate the elders from a cashless society?

- A) The leaking of personal information.
- B) The high price of smart phones.
- C) The app-based banking service.
- D) The poor network connection.

29. What can be learned from Passage C?

- A) The amount of cash that was spent in the U.S. in 2016 is less than that in Europe.
- B) The society will be cashless only when everyone has a debit card or a credit card.
- C) Europe will develop into a cashless society sooner than the United States.
- D) Both Visa and Mastercard have made profits in the transition to a cashless society.

30-31. Decide whether the statements are True or False.

30. According to Passage C, Visa, Mastercard and American Express, which have become the leading way of payment, promote the development of the cashless society in Europe and the U.S.

- A) True
- B) False

31. The authors of the three passages all have experienced the life with little or almost no cash.

- A) True
- B) False

Question 32 (Suggested completion time: 40 minutes)

Directions: *Read an excerpt from *How the Mind Works* by Steven Pinker. Write a short essay according to the excerpt.*

What shape are a beagle's ears? How many windows are in your living room? What's darker, a Christmas tree or a frozen pea? What's larger, a guinea pig or a gerbil? Does a lobster have a mouth? When a person stands up straight, is her navel above her wrist? If the letter *D* is turned on its back and put on top of a *J*, what does the combination remind you of?

Most people say that they answer these questions using a "mental image." They visualize the shape, which feels like conjuring up a picture available for inspection in the mind's eye. The feeling is quite unlike the experience of answering abstract questions, such as "What is your mother's maiden name?" or "What is more important, civil liberties or a lower rate of crime?"

Mental imagery is the engine that drives our thinking about objects in space. To load a car with suitcases or rearrange the furniture, we imagine the different spatial arrangements before we try them. The anthropologist Napoleon Chagnon described an ingenious use of mental imagery by the Yanomamo Indians of the Amazon rainforest. They had blown smoke down the opening of an armadillo (犛狴) hole to asphyxiate the animal, and then had to figure out where to dig to extract it from its tunnel, which could run underground for hundreds of feet. One of the Yanomamo men hit on the idea of threading a long vine with a knot at the end down the hole as far as it would go. The other men kept their ears to the ground listening for the knot bumping the sides of the burrow so they could get a sense of the direction in which the burrow ran. The first man broke off the vine, pulled it out, laid it along the ground, and began to dig where the end of the vine lay. A few feet down they struck armadillo. Without an ability to visualize the tunnel and the vine and armadillo inside it, the men would not have connected a sequence of threading, listening, yanking, breaking, measuring, and digging actions to an expectation of finding an animal corpse. In a joke we used to tell as children, two carpenters are hammering nails into the side of a house, and one asks the other why he is examining each nail as he takes it out of the box and throwing half of them away. "They're defective," replies the second carpenter, holding one up. "The pointy end is facing the wrong way." "You fool!" shouts the first carpenter. "Those are for the other side of the house!"

Write a short essay of about 300 words based on your understanding of the excerpt. Remember to write in your **OWN** words. Your essay should respond to the following questions:

1) What is the point that Steven Pinker tries to illustrate here?

2) How is the example about armadillo related to the point? What is the humour about the carpenters?

3) Can you give a different example to illustrate the point of the excerpt?